

From Black Gold to Paper Jokes: A Nigerian Tragedy in 3 Minutes

A Satirical Monologue by The Honest Nigerian

OPENING SCENE - 8 seconds

Setting: A well-dressed middle-aged Nigerian in sharp native attire sits facing the camera, perfectly lit, like a TED talk, but with the energy of a stand-up comedian who's dead inside.

THE HONEST NIGERIAN: (Smiling painfully) Good evening, my fellow sufferers! Today, let's talk about how we went from being oil-rich to just... rich in excuses. Grab your tissues – not for tears, but to wipe the sweat from calculating exchange rates.

SCENE 1: THE GOLDEN DELUSION - 8 seconds

Holds up an old Naira note like it's a museum artifact

Listen, when we created the Naira in 1973, we were pumping 823 million barrels of oil per year. EIGHT HUNDRED AND TWENTY-THREE MILLION! We were literally sitting on black gold, and our Naira? (Chef's kiss) 90 kobo to one dollar! Today? (Laughs bitterly) 1,600 Naira to one dollar. We basically turned our currency into a meme before memes existed.

SCENE 2: THE INTOXICATION PERIOD - 8 seconds

Leaning forward conspiratorially

Between 1973 and 1979, we had stability. Can you imagine? STABILITY! By 1980, oil was giving us 80% of government revenue and 96% of exports. We were Africa's biggest oil producer! One man could work, feed his family, send kids to school, and still have change for small chops. Now? (Laughs) Now both parents work three jobs and still eat garri for dinner while the kids Google "what is protein?"

SCENE 3: THE GENIUS DISCOVERY - 8 seconds

Standing up, gesturing wildly

But here's where it gets BEAUTIFUL! Between 1975 and 1985, we're pumping 1.8 to 2.3 million barrels daily. Our leaders looked at all the oil success and thought, "We are brilliant, not just 'smart'!" They discovered they could spend tomorrow's oil TODAY! Revolutionary! Why wait for actual oil when you can just... print the money now?

SCENE 4: THE PRINTING PARTY - 8 seconds

Mimicking a printing press with hand gestures

"We have oil reserves," they said. "So let's print Naira like we're making party flyers!" Need money for a new mansion – sorry, I mean "infrastructure project"? PRINT! Need money for a foreign trip – sorry, "diplomatic mission"? PRINT! Need money for your cousin's wedding – sorry, "cultural development initiative"? PRINT! PRINT! PRINT!

SCENE 5: THE REALITY CHECK - 8 seconds

Sitting back down, shaking his head

Then the 1980s said, "Hold my beer." Oil prices collapsed faster than our electricity grid! Suddenly, our black gold wasn't worth much, but we had printed enough Naira to wallpaper the entire country. The exchange rate went from 90 kobo in the '70s to 168 Naira by 2014, then said "why stop there?" and hit 899 by 2023, and 1,535 by 2024. July 2024? 1,600! At this rate, we'll need scientific notation to write exchange rates!

SCENE 6: STRUCTURAL ADJUSTMENT (AKA STRUCTURED DESTRUCTION) - 8 seconds

Standing again, pacing

1986! They introduced "Structural Adjustment" – which is government speak for "let's make the currency weaker ON PURPOSE!" It's like setting your own house on fire and calling it "thermal restructuring." Parents who used to raise their kids now outsource to schools, TV, and TikTok. Why? Because they're too busy working seventeen jobs to buy half a loaf of bread!

SCENE 7: THE BEAUTIFUL CASCADE - 8 seconds

Counting on fingers mockingly

So what did we achieve? Kids learned debt instead of savings – "Buy now, cry later!" We stopped producing anything except excuses. Empty factories, imported toothpicks, financing pure water on credit! Our money lost 99% of its value, but hey, at least we're consistent! The oil that made us strong became our curse – like that relative who won the lottery and ended up broke but with a really nice car.

SCENE 8: THE DEBT MATHEMATICS - 8 seconds

Pull out a calculator, pretending to calculate

"But we still have oil!" you say. Beautiful! Let me do the math for you. (Pretends to calculate) We've printed so much Naira that our oil would need to be worth... (looks at calculator)... approximately the price of unicorn tears mixed with dragon blood just to break even. We literally spent oil we haven't even discovered yet. Our great-grandchildren's oil? Already spent. Sorry, kids!

SCENE 9: THE PIVOT TO HOPE - 8 seconds

Leaning in with mock seriousness

But WAIT! There's hope! Just as we moved from farming (which we abandoned) to oil (which we mismanaged), the world is moving to digital gold! Mathematics-based money that politicians CAN'T print! Can you imagine? Money they can't multiply during election season?

SCENE 10: THE DIGITAL SALVATION - 8 seconds

Holding up a phone

This new gold has what oil never had – absolute scarcity. Twenty-one million maximum. FOREVER. No midnight printing sessions, no "quantitative easing," no "fiscal stimulus packages" that stimulate nothing but inflation. When they try to print more? The computer says NO! It's beautiful! It's like giving politicians a credit card that actually declines!

SCENE 11: THE GENERATIONAL WISDOM - 8 seconds

Walking closer to camera

Every generation gets to choose its money. Our parents chose oil – not bad! Then chose to print it into poverty – very bad! We can choose mathematics. We can choose code. We can choose something that even the most creative accountant general cannot manipulate. Bitcoin sitting there at 21 million max while our leaders are still trying to figure out how to print tomorrow's tomorrow's tomorrow's oil money.

CLOSING SCENE - 8 seconds

Sitting back, adjusting his agbada with a knowing smile

THE HONEST NIGERIAN: (Directly to camera) From black gold to paper jokes – what a journey! We had the strongest currency in Africa because it was backed by actual oil in our ground. Then we replaced it with promises, IOUs, and vibes. But hey, at least we're number one at something – currency devaluation! Nigeria, we too much!

(Winks at camera) Choose your foundation wisely, my people. Because if you don't, someone else will choose poverty for you and call it "economic policy." Ire ooo!

FADE TO BLACK

TEXT APPEARS:

- "1970s: ₦0.90 = \$1"
- "2024: ₦1,600 = \$1"
- "That's not inflation. That's magic!"
- "From Black Gold to Paper Promises"
- "Maybe try Digital Gold this time?"
- *Bitcoin icon appears*

Total Runtime: 96 seconds + transitions = Perfect 3-minute social media content

All Historical Facts:

- 823 million barrels by 1973
- 90 kobo to \$1 in the 1970s
- 80% government revenue, 96% exports by 1980
- 1.8-2.3M barrels/day (1975-1985)
- Complete devaluation timeline through 2024
- 1986 Structural Adjustment Program
- Current rate is 1,600 per dollar